

Staffing Ratio Cheat Sheet

Right-Sizing Your Team | for new team leads

Our ratio: 1 rep handles about 6 calls an hour, so 1 : 6. Your team's number: _____ calls per rep per hour

I need to know...	Do this	Example
How many reps for a forecast	Reps = forecast ÷ calls one rep handles per hour. Always round up.	$90 \div 6 = 15$ reps $45 \div 6 = 7.5$, so roster 8
Whether my ratio is right	Cross-multiply. If both products match, the ratios are equivalent.	1 : 6 and 15 : 90 $1 \times 90 = 90$ and $6 \times 15 = 90$. Match.
What to do when the forecast changes	Work out the factor (new ÷ old). Change the team by the same factor.	$90 \rightarrow 120$ is $\times 4/3$ $15 \text{ reps} \times 4/3 = 20 \text{ reps}$
How long a job takes when people are off	The work is fixed, so reps $\times$ hours = total rep-hours. Hours = total rep-hours ÷ reps.	Backlog = 48 rep-hours 8 reps: 6 hours. 6 reps: 8 hours. 12 reps: 4 hours.
How to split reps across queues	1. Add the parts. 2. Total reps ÷ sum of parts = reps in one part. 3. Multiply each part. Check they add back to the total.	20 reps at 5 : 3 : 2 $5 + 3 + 2 = 10$; $20 \div 10 = 2$ Voice 10, Chat 6, Email 4

Quick lookup: reps needed at 1 : 6

Forecast (calls/hr)	30	60	90	120
Reps needed (at 1 : 6)	5	10	15	20

Before you decide

- ☐ Does reps $\times$ calls per rep cover the forecast? ($17 \text{ reps} \times 6 = 102$, and 120 are coming, so no.)
- ☐ What does the fix cost somewhere else? Moving reps off a backlog makes it take longer. Check the new hours.
- ☐ Did I round up, and do my queue numbers add back to the total?
- ☐ Trainees count as part of a rep. At 4 calls an hour, each is worth $4/6$ of an experienced rep.

The ratio is a starting point. Real rosters also have to allow for breaks, training and absences. Figures here are from the BrightLine Support example in the course and are illustrative.